THE WHEEL OF STRATEGY

20 practical questions to help leaders guide a company

What is this guide?
It is a simple strategy checklist. It helps a company's leaders think clearly about why the company exists, who it serves, what it wants to achieve, and what work needs to happen next. You do not need perfect answers immediately. Use the questions to start useful discussions and improve your answers over time.

1. PURPOSE & DIRECTION

Why the company exists and where it is going.

1. Why does our company exist, and who genuinely needs what we offer?
2. What is our mission in one clear sentence?
3. What beliefs and values guide the way we work?
4. Where do we want the company to be in three years?
5. What would success look like if we achieved what we are aiming for?

2. MARKET & ADVANTAGE

Who we serve, what they need, and why they might choose us.

1. Who are the customers we most want to serve?
2. What problems or frustrations do these customers face regularly?
3. What is changing in our industry, and how can we prepare for it?
4. Why do customers choose us—or choose another option instead?
5. What can we offer that would be difficult for competitors to copy?

3. GOALS & MEASURES

What matters most and how we will know whether we are making progress.

1. What are our three most important priorities right now?
2. What should we achieve by the end of this quarter?
3. What is the most important number or result we should watch right now?
4. How will we check our progress every week?
5. What important milestone would show that we are moving in the right direction?

4. ACTIONS & NEXT STEPS

The work that needs to happen, who will do it, and when.

1. What must we deliver in the next 90 days?
2. Who is responsible for each result, and when is it due?
3. What is currently slowing us down, and what can we do to remove the obstacle?
4. What small, useful wins can we achieve soon to build momentum?
5. When will we review our plan, and how will we make changes if needed?

HOW TO USE THESE QUESTIONS

- **Discuss:** Bring the leadership team together and answer one section at a time.
- **Be specific:** Replace general statements with clear examples, numbers, and dates where possible.
- **Write it down:** Keep the agreed answers in one shared company document.
- **Assign responsibility:** Turn important answers into tasks with a named owner and deadline.
- **Review:** Revisit the plan regularly—especially when customers, the market, or company priorities change.

Remember: strategy is not just having big ambitions. It is making clear choices about where the company is going and organizing the work to move in that direction.